

Fundraising



- Head of Incubator in VNU
- Co-founder of Fundwise - a one-stop shop for fundraising
- Founder of TAOStartup Community - 20,000 members
- Start 6 business/startup and fail.
- Got certificate of Venture Deals course by Techstars

Money is the fuel for your company



Startup Capital



Bootstrapping



Family and Friends (Pre-seed)



Angel Investors



Seed Investors



Accelerator/Incubator



Crowdfunding



Equity Crowdfunding



Bank Loans



SBA Loans



Government Grants and Loans



Online Lenders



Convertible Notes



Venture Capital

Fundraising stage

Stages Of A Startup Equity Funding



Venture Capital vs Private Equity

What's the difference?

	Stage of investment				
	Angel	Seed	Growth	Crossover	Late Stage / Buyout
Investment Size (US\$)	US\$10K - US\$250K	US\$250K - US\$2M	US\$10M - US\$50M	US\$50M - US\$100M	Depends. Could be millions to billions.
Holding Period (Years)	8 - 10 years	6 - 8 years	5 - 7 years	> 5 years	3 - 5 years
Return Expectation (% Per Year Or Multiple)	>75% IRR or +10x	>60% IRR or +10x	>40% IRR or +7x	~25 to 35% IRR or +5x	>18% IRR or +3x
Investor Type / Stage	Individuals or group of individuals	First institutional check	Series A through C	Series C through IPO	Majority control / debt financed
Firms Involved (Reference Only)	     	      	     	       	        

The current fundraising environment...

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Venture Fundraising Hits Nine-Year Low

Slowdown that earlier hit tech startups catches up with investors who fuel venture capital

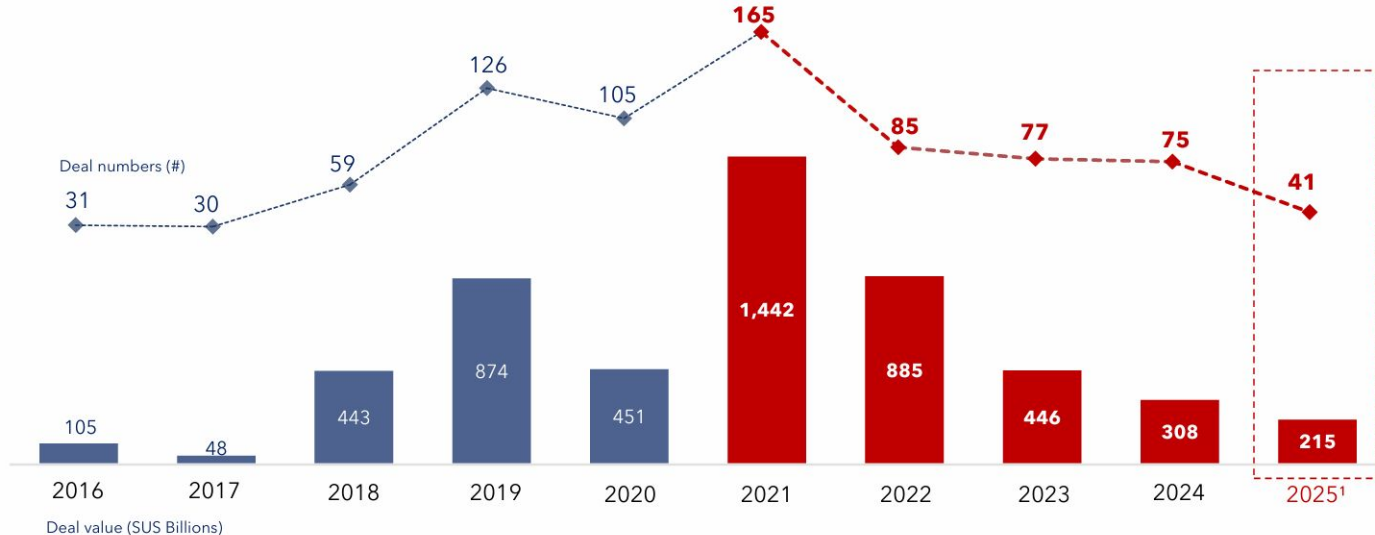


- Early stage is harder than later stages
- Singaporean, Japanese and Korean investors are still active in Vietnam, but less deals

The current fundraising environment...

By the end of 2025, Vietnam VC Deal Value continues to decline by ~30% 

Venture capital activity cycle 2016-2025 (illustrative),
Total deal value and deal count



In 2025, Vietnam's VC deal count contracted sharply to 41 deals and deal size reduced to 215 millions, extending the decline from the 2021 peak. This continuous adjustment reflects not only global funding stress, but also a structural shift in investor thesis following 5-year cycle of market observation: where earlier investments are now revealing answers, reducing appetite for unproven business models

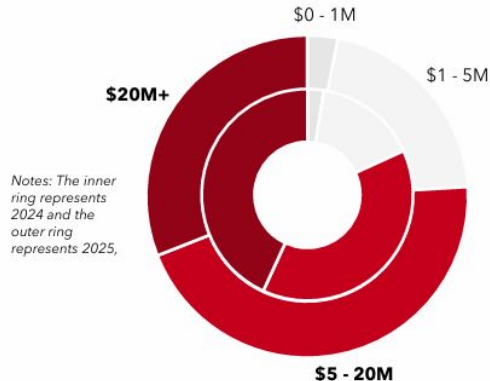
The current fundraising environment...

The market didn't merely shrink, it shifted where capital flows



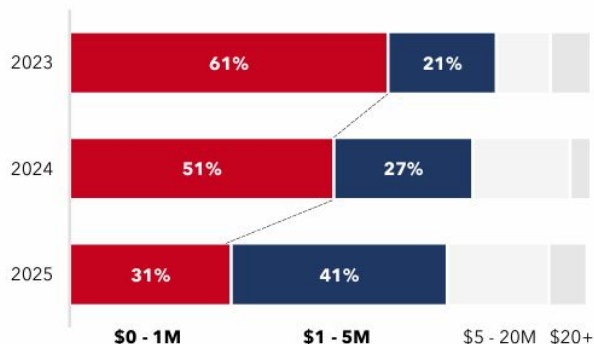
Venture capital allocation by deal stage,

Total deal value distribution by deal range, 2025 (SUSM)



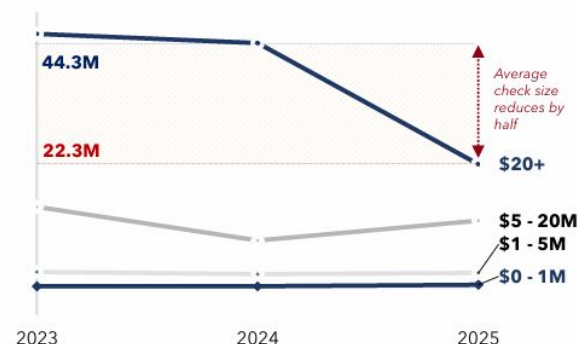
The rebalancing of venture capital deployment

Share of total deal number by deal range, 2023-2025 (SUSM)



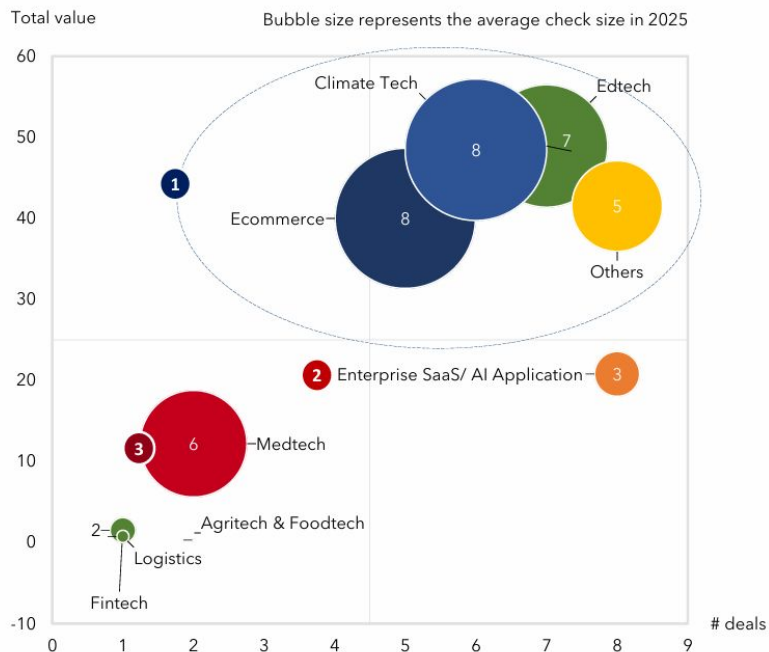
Average venture investment ticket evolution by stage,

Average check size by deal range, 2023-2025 (SUSM)



The current fundraising environment...

Vietnam VC Funding Deal Size and Deal Value 2025, By Sector



New trend of VCs

There is a shift away from regional consumer businesses to global enterprise businesses

2021 — TOP 5 FUNDING ROUNDS

	 sea	\$6B ¹
	 Grab	\$4.5B
	 J&T EXPRESS	\$2.0B
	 bukalapak	\$1.5B
	 goto	\$1.3B

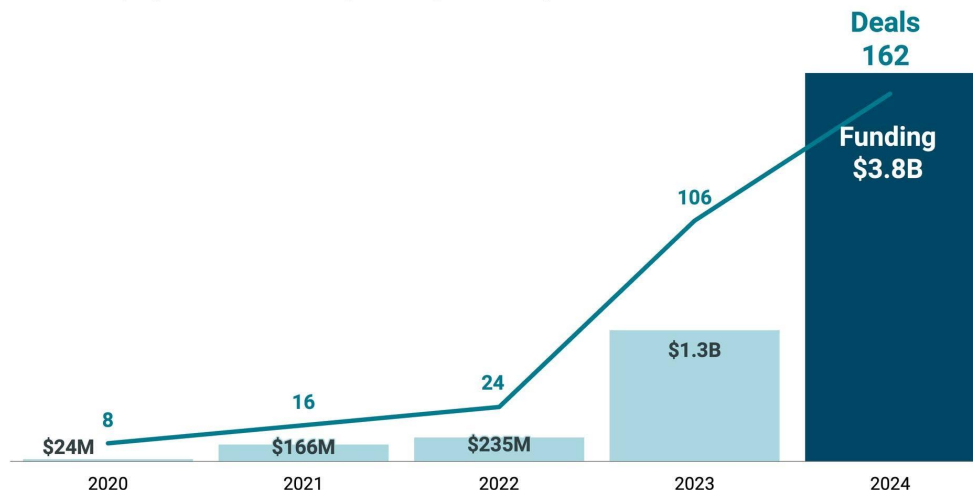
2025² — TOP 5 FUNDING ROUNDS

	 airalo	\$220M
	 supabase	\$200M
	 Airwallex	\$150M
	 Thunes	\$150M
	 bolttech	\$147M

New trend of VCs

AI agents have entered the conversation

Disclosed equity deals and funding to AI agent startups



Source: CB Insights financing data (as of 2/27/2025). For the purposes of a funding analysis, excludes LLM developers and companies where agents are not their primary product offering (e.g., Replit, Intercom, etc.). Includes agentic applications and agent-specific infrastructure.

New trend of VCs

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Services: The New Software

BY [JULIEN BEK](#)

PUBLISHED MARCH 5, 2026

The next \$1T company will be a software company masquerading as a services firm.

New trend of VCs

AI + Hardware
AI + Deeptech

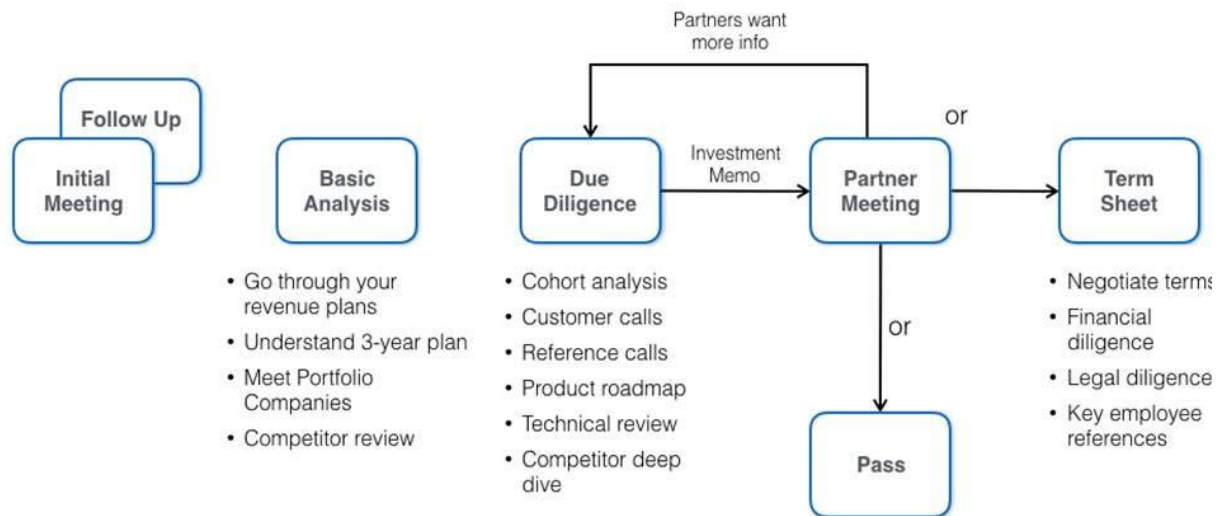


Request for Startups Summer 2026 vs Spring 2026

Summer 2026	Spring 2026
1. AI for Low-Pesticide Agriculture AI, robotics, and biology to cut pesticide use and raise yields.	1. Cursor for Product Managers AI product discovery that turns feedback and usage into specs.
2. AI-Native Service Companies AI-native firms that sell the service itself, not just software.	2. AI-Native Hedge Funds Agents research markets, generate theses, and execute trades.
3. AI Personalized Medicine Agents, diagnostics, and therapies for highly individualized care.	3. AI-Native Agencies Service firms powered by AI with software-like margins.
4. Company Brain Turn fragmented company knowledge into executable AI context.	4. Stablecoin Financial Services Compliant stablecoin rails for yield, payments, and new assets.
5. Counter-Swarm Defense Software-first defense against cheap, coordinated drone swarms.	5. AI for Government Automate public-sector forms, workflows, and service delivery.
6. Dynamic Software Interfaces Let users and agents reshape software around their workflows.	6. Modern Metal Mills Software-defined mills with better automation and energy economics.
7. Electronics in Space Build space-optimized inference chips for orbital compute.	7. AI Guidance for Physical Work Real-time AI copilots for hands-on jobs in the field.
8. Hardware Supply Chain Compress hardware iteration with faster manufacturing and logistics.	8. Large Spatial Models Foundation models built for 2D and 3D spatial reasoning.
9. Industrial Capabilities in Space Create lunar and in-space industrial production systems.	9. Infra for Government Fraud Hunters Turn tips and messy evidence into complaint-ready fraud cases.
10. Inference Chips for Agent Workflows Silicon designed for agent loops, context switching, and memory.	10. Make LLMs Easy to Train Better tooling, data infra, and APIs for model training.
11. SaaS Challengers Build AI-native challengers to entrenched software incumbents.	
12. Software for Agents APIs, CLIs, and tools built for AI agents as users.	
13. Sell to Huge Companies Use AI to win and serve Fortune 100 customers early.	
14. Supply Chain 2.0 for Semiconductors Modern tooling for chip allocation, risk, and compliance.	
15. AI Operating System for Companies Make every company queryable, legible, and self-improving.	

Typical VC process

Typical VC Process



Steps of fundraising

1. Identify amount of funding
2. Identify type of capital
3. Identify ideal investors
4. Prepare fundraising material, data room
5. Approach investors & set up meeting
6. Due diligence
7. Sign term sheet & close deal



Keys to successful fundraising

- Credible, **committed** founder(s)
- **Provable** market need
- **Big** vision – with a believable path
- **Differentiated**, defensible **solution**
- **Compelling** plan (product, GTM, financial)
- The **right** investors

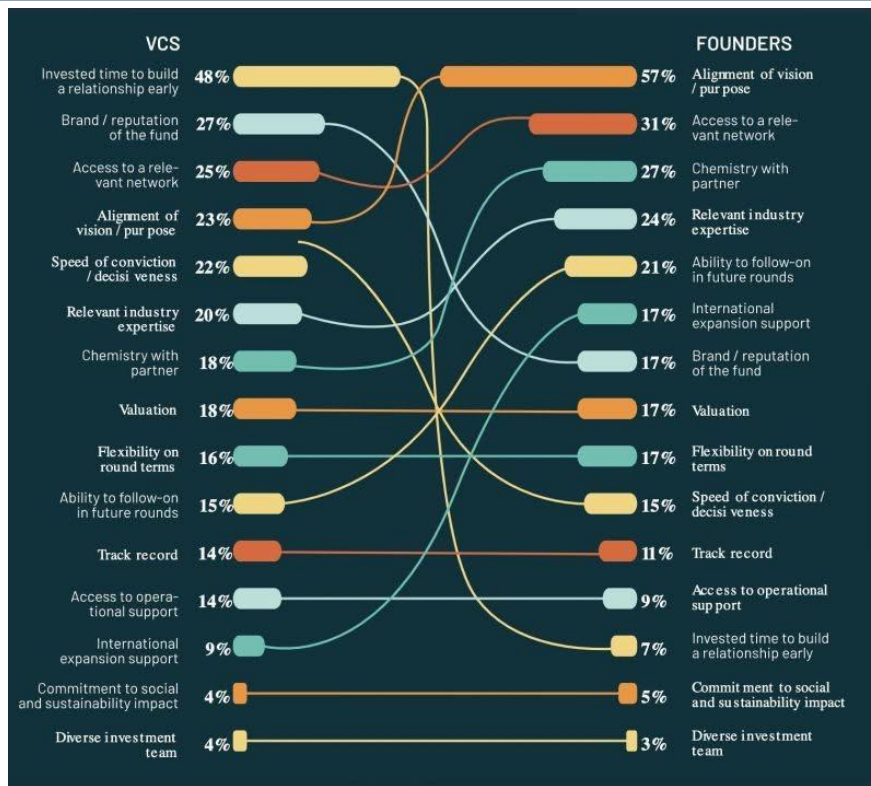


Common issues

- Lack of focus (founders, company)
- “Tech-first” vs. “customer-first” mindset
- Failure to paint the big/long-term picture
- Unclear differentiation (“we’re using AI!!!”)
- Unclear financials
 - Unit economics, cash needs, KPIs to next financing
- Poor qualification of investors
 - “10 VCs want to meet with us!!”



What founder want, what VCs give



What to know before/after an investor meeting

- Money available to invest now?
- “Investment thesis”?
 - Categories, markets, etc.
- Current investments?
 - Companies
 - Do they know your space? Competitive investments?
 - Typical “ticket size”
 - Investment criteria
 - Team, market, stage, % equity requirements, ...
- Why would they invest in you now - or not?



- *Be selective!!!*
- *Ask questions!!!*
- *Don't waste your time!!!*

How to find good investors



1. Referrals are the best

Portfolio Organizations Headquarters Location includes any Vietnam x C

Investor Type includes any Venture Capital x Angel, Fund of Funds, Ventur

Operating Status equals Active

+ Add Organizations filter

SEARCH 1-5 of 303 results

☐	Organization Name v	Industries v	Headquarters Location v
☐	1. Techstars	Consulting, Finance, Financial Serv...	Boulder, Colorado, United States
☐	2. Antler	Finance, Financial Services, Ventur...	Singapore, Central Region, Singa
☐	3. 500 Global	Finance, Financial Services, Fundi...	San Francisco, California, United

2. Lists (if you have to)

How to find good investors



3. Events, workshops



4. Be famous

Do's and Don'ts



- Don't OVER-PROMISE
 - Set expectations that you will meet or exceed



- Be HONEST, and TRANSPARENT
 - Deliver bad news faster than good news



- Think LONG TERM– and remember it's a small world
 - Focus on building the company, not the exit



- Be CONSISTENT
 - Many management styles can succeed - pick one and stay with it



Q&A